APPROVED ON MARCH 18, 2026
BY THE BOARD OF COUNTY COMMISSIONERS
AT THE WEEKLY BUSINESS SESSION

WEEKLY BUSINESS SESSION – March 11, 2026
5:30pm. – Anne Basker Auditorium
600 N.W. Sixth Street, Grants Pass, OR 97526

Present: Ron Smith, Chair-Commissioner; Colene Martin, Vice-Chair-Commissioner and Gary Richardson, Commissioner, Nikole Guzman, Recorder

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These are meeting minutes only. Only text enclosed in quotation marks reports a speaker's exact words.

Pursuant to notice through the media and in conformance with the Public Meeting Law, Ron Smith, Chair, called the meeting to order at 5:30 p.m. followed by the Pledge of Allegiance.

Items discussed were as follows:

1. **CALL MEETING TO ORDER:** Pursuant to notice through the media and in conformance with the Public Meeting Law, Ron Smith, Chair, called the meeting to order at 5:30 p.m.

2. **DECLARE A POTENTIAL CONFLICT OF INTEREST:**
The commissioners reserved their right to declare a potential conflict of interest.

3. **Public Hearing: In the Matter of Annexations to the Josephine Community Library District by Petition of Landowner without Election**

Order Number	Petitioner	Assessor Map/Tax Lot	Acres
2026-002	STONE TRUST, GLORIA I	40-08-34-00-001214-00	0.78
2026-003	OAKES, LAUREN AND HIRSH, LOGAN	40-08-04-00-000607-00	5.00

Commissioner Smith opened the public hearing at 5:31 p.m.

Commissioner Smith opened the floor to Public Testimony: (Each person given Three (3) Minutes to speak):
Kate Laskey, Josephine Community Library District, provided an overview of the annexation process, explaining that property owners voluntarily petition to join the district, the Library Board reviews and endorses the request, and the matter is then brought before the Board of Commissioners for final approval.

Commissioner Martin made a motion to approve Board Oder 2026-002, Seconded by Commissioner Richardson. Upon roll call, Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0

Commissioner Richardson made a motion to approve Board Oder 2026-003, Seconded by Commissioner Martin. Upon roll call, Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0

Public Hearing closed at 5:34 p.m.

4. **ADMINISTRATIVE ACTION(S) IN CONSIDERATION OF:**
   a. **Southern Oregon Sanitation (SOS) – Kerby Transfer Station – Rate Increase**

Trent Carpenter presented a detailed overview of the financial condition of the Kerby Transfer Station, including operational history, financial losses, and recommendations developed in coordination with the Solid Waste Agency. Mr. Carpenter explained that the Kerby Transfer Station has experienced significant financial losses over multiple years, averaging approximately -30% profitability, and that prior efforts to reduce hours and adjust operations have not sufficiently offset those costs. He noted that the facility's relatively low volume compared to other regional transfer stations continues to contribute to ongoing deficits. Mr. Carpenter stated that the Solid Waste Agency recommended a combination of a gate rate increase and a subsidy applied to residential customers as the most balanced approach. He further outlined options available to the Board, including taking no action, which would allow the default recommendation to take effect, adjusting the subsidy levels or rate structure, or exploring alternative funding mechanisms. Exhibit 1 Solid Waste System Changes Printed PowerPoint

Commissioners discussed operational efficiencies, including the potential impact of reducing operating days, maintaining service to Illinois Valley residents, and balancing subsidy impacts across ratepayers.

b. **Board Order No. 2026-005; In the Matter of the Sale of County Land Remaining Unsold Following Sheriff's Auction of September 17, 2025; Quitclaim Deed for Sale of County Land located at Winona Rd – R302226**

Wally Hicks, County Counsel, presented the sale of approximately 0.69 acres acquired through tax foreclosure, explaining that the property was originally offered at Sheriff's auction on September 17, 2025, and was subsequently made available for over-the-counter sale. He stated that the County received a full cash offer for the property and that proceeds from the sale would be applied toward outstanding taxes and associated costs, with any remaining balance to be deposited into surplus funds.

c. **Board Order No. 2026-006; In the Matter of Uniform Procedure for Setting Fees Charged by County and Setting a Public Hearing: Community Development – Planning April 1, 2026 at 9:00 a.m.**

Ruth Nelson, Finance Director, presented a request to set a public hearing for April 1, 2026, regarding proposed fee changes. James Black, Planning Manager, provided additional detail on the proposed fee structures related to the annual compliance program, explaining that the fees were developed using a cost-based methodology reflecting staff time and administrative processing. He outlined a proposed late fee structure of $250 for applications submitted 30 days late and $500 for those submitted after 60 days, noting that the fees also account for increased administrative workload and are intended to improve participation and compliance rates within the program.

5. **REQUESTS/COMMENTS FROM CITIZENS:** *(Each person will be given three (3) minutes to speak)*

Chad Hansen, Josephine County, spoke in opposition to recent Planning Department hires and raised concerns regarding budget process and staffing justification.

Tracy Thompson, Josephine County, Discussed County banking practices, due diligence processes, and suggested prioritizing local financial institutions. Submitted a Request for Proposals document (Exhibit 2).

Connor Kirkpatrick, Josephine County, commented on solid waste subsidy structure, environmental program fees, and geographic equity of rate impacts; also referenced prior solid waste mitigation proposal.

Victor, Grants Pass, spoke regarding enforcement of the clear bag policy and raised questions about transfer station cost impacts.

Jason Kennedy, City of Grants Pass / Solid Waste Agency, provided clarification regarding the temporary nature of the recommended rate structure and agency evaluation process.

Matt Spurlock, Grants Pass, spoke regarding County financial matters, including prior discussions related to County facilities and debt obligations

Jay Merideth, Grants Pass, spoke in favor of the current Board and spoke in concern to the Mining Application and Litigation issue.

6. **BOARD MAY REVIEW PUBLIC COMMENTS/QUESTIONS:**

The Board addressed public comments

Board Discussion and Action – Agenda Item 4(a)

Commissioner Richardson made a motion to approve Southern Oregon Sanitation (SOS) – Kerby Transfer Station – Rate Increase, seconded by Commissioner Martin. Upon roll call, Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.

Board Discussion and Action – Agenda Item 4(b)

Commissioner Richardson made a motion to approve Board Order No. 2026-005; In the Matter of the Sale of County Land Remaining Unsold Following Sheriff's Auction of September 17, 2025; Quitclaim Deed for Sale of County

Land located at Winona Rd – R302226, seconded by Commissioner Martin. Upon roll call, Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.

Board Discussion and Action – Agenda Item 4(c)
Commissioner Richardson made a motion to approve Board Order No. 2026-006; In the Matter of Uniform Procedure for Setting Fees Charged by County and Setting a Public Hearing: Community Development -, seconded by Commissioner Martin. Upon roll call, Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.

7. **APPROVAL OF CONSENT CALENDAR:**
   a. **Minutes** *(Draft minutes are available for viewing in the Board's Office)*
   Admin Workshop – March 3, 2026
   Weekly Business Session – March 4, 2026
   Board Journal December 2025
   Board Journal January 2026
   Commissioner Martin made a motion to approve the Consent Calendar, seconded by Commissioner Richardson. Upon roll call, Commissioner Richardson – yes, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 3-0.

8. **OTHER: (ORS 192.640(1))** *". . . notice shall include a list of the principal subjects anticipated to be considered at the meeting, but this requirement shall not limit the ability of a governing body to consider additional subjects.")*
   Commissioner Richardson raised concerns regarding the vacancy of the Emergency Management Director position, prompting discussion among the Board regarding potential intergovernmental agreements for support, the recruitment and hiring process, and funding sources, which have historically been shared between grant funding and the general fund. Staff, including representatives from Human Resources and Finance, provided clarification and additional context regarding these considerations.

9. **ANNOUNCEMENTS: MATTERS FROM COMMISSIONERS:**

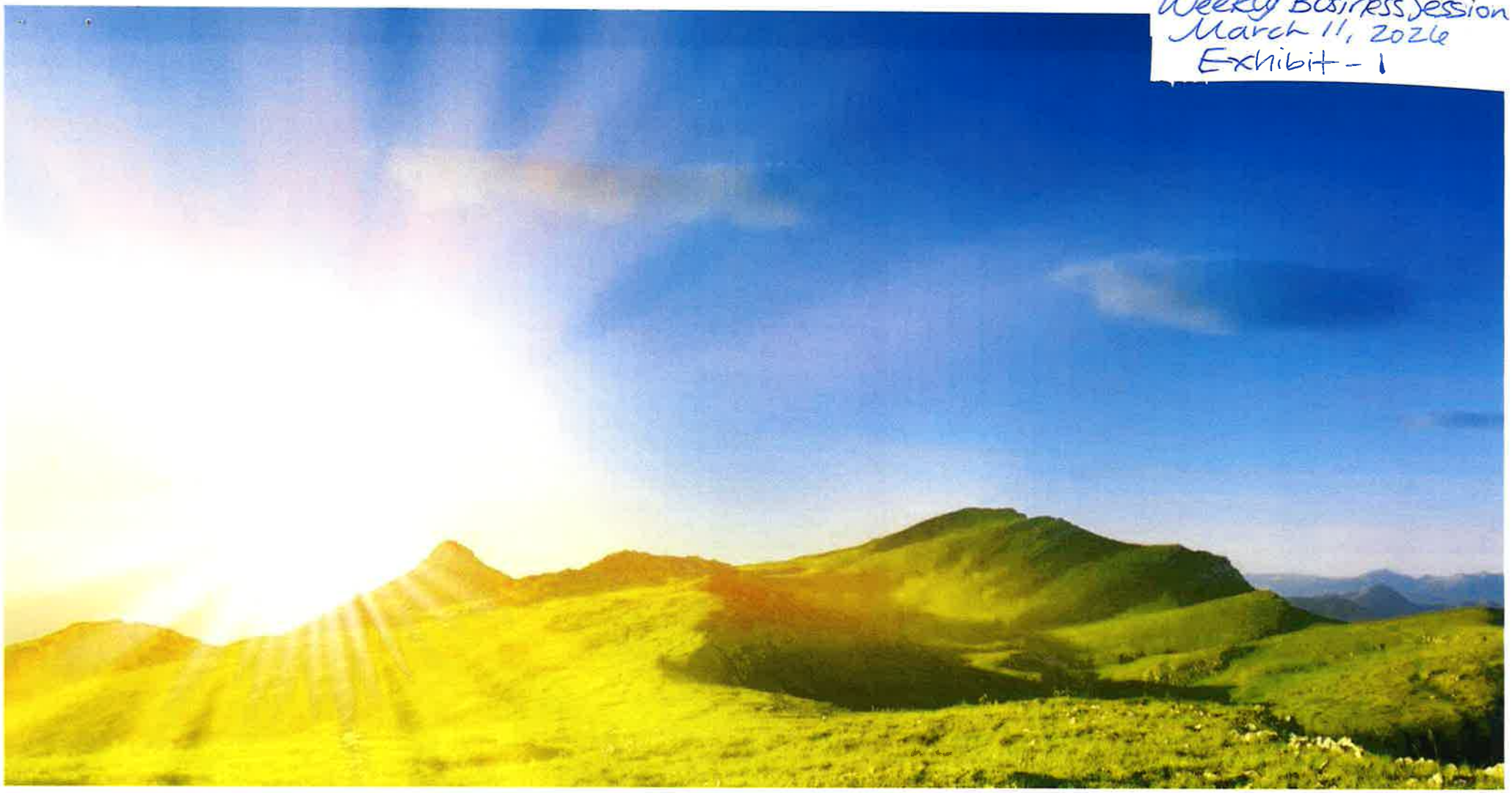
   None

Weekly Business Session adjourned at 6:36 p.m.

Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Exhibit 1- Solid Waste System Changes PowerPoint
Exhibit 2 – Request for Proposals

Weekly Business Session
March 11, 2026
Exhibit - 1



Solid Waste System Changes

Kerby Transfer Station(KTS)

* KTS volume and distance make it impossible to have same rates as other transfer stations in the area without subsidization.
* In the last 3 years KTS
  * Losses of $571,000.00
  * Average Profitability of -30%
* Solid Waste Agency had 3 different public meetings over the last 6 months

Looking at the 2-year averages

	2023/2024
Josephine County Hauling Only	10.4%
Kerby Transfer Station Only	-31.2%
Combined	5.3%

Directed to present a combination

* Rate Increase on KTS services
* Section 5.5.2 Hauling customers subsidize
* Off set with Franchise fees paid to Josephine County
  * 2024 $317,000
  * 2025 $ 341,000
* **Combination of above**
* Close the Kerby Transfer Station

The Numbers

* 2-year average Revenue
  * $419,077
* 2-year average Expense
  * $610,259
* Amount needed to meet Franchise requirements per year
  * $259,500

Using a combination of rate increases

KTS Rate Increase %	New Loose Yard ($19.30)	JoCo Monthly Surcharge (8000 Customers)
10.0%	$ 21.25	$ 2.25
20.0%	**$ 23.15**	**$ 1.80**
40.0%	$ 27.00	$ 0.95
60.0%	$ 30.90	$ 0.10

Next Steps

* We are in the 60-day time period from the SWAC notification.
* BCC can take no action, and the rates will change or may modify the rate increase methodology and that will take effect

Weekly Business Session
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Exhibit 2

REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS

Banking and Financial Depository Services

Josephine County, Oregon

Issue Date: _____, 2026
Proposal Deadline: _____, 2026, 4:00 PM PDT
Contact: Josephine County Finance Department | [address] | [email] | [phone]

1. Introduction & Purpose

Josephine County, Oregon ("the County") invites proposals from qualified financial institutions to provide comprehensive banking and depository services for all County funds, departments, and agencies.

The County's objectives are to:

1. Ensure the **safety and liquidity** of public funds in full compliance with Oregon law (including ORS Chapter 295 and all applicable state and local requirements).
2. Obtain **reliable, cost-effective banking services** that support efficient County operations.
3. Maximize the **local economic benefit of public deposits**, consistent with the County's adopted economic development goals and its commitment to supporting locally rooted financial institutions where feasible and lawful.

The County currently maintains its primary banking relationship with First Interstate Bank and is issuing this RFP to review available options and ensure that its depository arrangements best serve the public interest going forward.

The resulting contract is expected to have an **initial term of three (3) years**, with up to two (2) additional one-year renewal options at the County's sole discretion.

2. Scope of Services

Proposals must address the following services. For each, indicate whether it is offered, how it is delivered, and all associated fees.

2.1 Core Depository Services

- Operating accounts (general, payroll, and other checking accounts).
- Interest-bearing accounts for reserves and capital funds.
- Sweep or earnings credit arrangements, if offered.
- Compliance with all **public funds collateralization** and reporting requirements under Oregon law.

2.2 Disbursement Services

- Check processing and clearing.
- ACH origination and receipt.
- Domestic wire transfers (incoming and outgoing).
- Positive Pay or similar fraud-prevention tools.
- Stop-payment processing and dispute resolution.

2.3 Collections & Receipts

- Lockbox services (if available).
- Remote deposit capture.
- Electronic payments for taxes, fees, and other County receivables.
- Merchant card processing or integration with third-party processors.

2.4 Reporting & Reconciliation

- Online banking with multi-user access and role-based permissions.
- Same-day or next-day balance and transaction reporting.
- Monthly account statements (electronic and/or paper).
- Ability to export data in formats compatible with the County's financial software (currently [system]).

2.5 Optional Services

- Short-term liquidity facilities or lines of credit, if permitted under Oregon law.
- Procurement card (P-card) programs.

- Other value-added services beneficial to a county-level public entity.

3. Mandatory Eligibility Requirements

To be considered, a responding institution must, at the time of proposal:

1. Be **authorized to conduct banking business in the State of Oregon**.
2. Be a **qualified depository for public funds** and fully compliant with ORS Chapter 295 (Public Funds Collateralization).
3. Be insured by the **FDIC** (or NCUA, for applicable institutions) for at least $250,000 per depositor.
4. Maintain at least one **full-service branch within Josephine County or an immediately adjacent county** that is reasonably accessible to County staff.
5. Meet the federal regulatory definition of **"Well Capitalized"** (or the functional equivalent), with no outstanding formal enforcement actions from bank regulators within the last five (5) years.

Proposals from institutions not meeting all mandatory requirements will be deemed non-responsive.

4. Preference for Locally Owned Institutions

In alignment with its economic development objectives, the County **intends to give preference, within the bounds of applicable law**, to financial institutions that are:

- **Locally owned** or mutually owned, and
- **Headquartered in Southern Oregon**, or
- Demonstrably **community-focused**, with a primary business model of lending and investment in Josephine County and the surrounding region.

This preference will be implemented through the evaluation criteria in Section 5 and will be based on **objective, documented factors**, not on the name or identity of any particular institution.

Nothing in this RFP shall be construed to guarantee award to any specific institution. The County will maintain a **competitive, nondiscriminatory process** and will ensure that all qualified institutions are fairly evaluated.

5. Evaluation Criteria

Responsive proposals will be evaluated using the following weighted criteria (total 100 points):

5.1 Local Ownership, Community Reinvestment & Economic Impact — 30 Points

A. Local Ownership / Governance (10 points)

- Whether the institution is locally owned, mutually owned, or community-chartered.
- Location of corporate headquarters (Southern Oregon, elsewhere in Oregon, or out-of-state).
- Extent to which governance and strategic decisions are made locally versus by a distant parent.

B. Local Lending & Investment Activity (15 points)

- Percentage of total loans (by dollar volume) outstanding **within Josephine County and the Rogue Valley region**.
- Volume of small business, agricultural, and mortgage loans originated locally over the past 24 months.
- Documented community development or public-sector lending activity in the region.

C. Community Reinvestment & Participation (5 points)

- CRA rating, if applicable.
- Participation in local community initiatives, affordable housing, economic development projects, or nonprofit support.
- Local employment levels (number of FTEs in Josephine County / Rogue Valley).

  Note: Locally owned banks and mutual institutions are expected to score strongly here, but any institution may earn points if it demonstrates substantial local lending and reinvestment.

5.2 Cost of Services & Earnings Potential — 25 Points

- Comprehensive fee schedule for all services in Section 2.
- Earnings credit rate (ECR) and/or interest rates on County deposits.

- Estimated **net annual cost** to the County, after applying earnings credits or interest.
- Any proposed fee waivers or incentives.

The proposal with the lowest net annual cost will be awarded maximum points; others will be scored proportionally.

5.3 Safety, Soundness & Regulatory Standing — 20 Points

- Capital ratios (Tier 1 leverage, risk-based capital).
- CAMELS or equivalent supervisory rating (if disclosable).
- Confirmation of **"Well Capitalized"** status.
- Absence of material enforcement actions, consent orders, or significant regulatory penalties within the past five (5) years.
- Description of the institution's risk management and public funds collateralization practices.

This criterion ensures that **safety of public funds is paramount**, regardless of institution size or ownership structure.

5.4 Technology, Service Capability & Customer Support — 15 Points

- Quality and reliability of online banking, ACH, and wire platforms.
- Availability of features such as Positive Pay, dual authorization, user-level controls, and alerts.
- Integration options with the County's financial software.
- Proposed service team structure, including a **designated relationship manager** and escalation contacts.
- Proximity and accessibility of branch and support staff for County business.

5.5 Transition Plan & Implementation — 10 Points

- Detailed plan and timeline for transitioning existing County accounts from First Interstate Bank (and any other current institutions) with **minimal disruption**.

- Approach to coordinating cut-over for payroll, ACH, wire templates, and merchant card arrangements.
- Training and support for County Finance staff during implementation.

6. Proposal Submission Requirements

Proposals must include, in this order:

1. **Cover Letter** signed by an authorized officer, confirming:
    - The institution meets all mandatory eligibility requirements.
    - The proposal is valid for at least 90 days from the submission deadline.
2. **Institution Profile**
    - Ownership structure (publicly traded, mutual, locally owned, etc.).
    - Year founded and corporate headquarters location.
    - Branch locations in Josephine County / Rogue Valley.
    - Summary of regulatory standing.
3. **Detailed Response to Scope of Services** (Section 2) and **Fee Schedule**.
4. **Local Economic Impact Section** addressing all items in Section 5.1 (local ownership, lending, CRA/community involvement, and employment).
5. **Safety & Soundness Documentation** (capital ratios, ratings if available, summary of enforcement history).
6. **Technology & Service Description**, including screenshots or literature for online platforms.
7. **Transition Plan** from current providers (including First Interstate Bank) to the respondent's institution.
8. **References**
    - At least three (3) public sector or large institutional clients, preferably in Oregon or similar jurisdictions.
9. **Exceptions & Proposed Contract Terms**

- Any exceptions to the County's standard terms must be clearly identified.

Proposals must be submitted as:

- One (1) original signed hard copy,
- Three (3) additional hard copies, and
- One (1) electronic copy (PDF) on USB or via secure email,

to:

Josephine County Finance Department
[Street Address]
Grants Pass, OR 97526
Attn: Banking Services RFP

7. Timeline

Milestone	Date
RFP Issued	_____, 2026
Deadline for Questions	_____, 2026
Responses to Questions Issued	_____, 2026
Proposals Due	_____, 2026, 4:00 PM PDT
Evaluation & Shortlisting	_____ – _____, 2026
Interviews / Presentations (if needed)	_____, 2026
Board of Commissioners Award	_____, 2026
Contract Start / Transition Begins	_____, 2026

8. General Terms

- The County reserves the right to **reject any or all proposals**, waive informalities, and accept the proposal deemed most advantageous to the public interest.
- Issuance of this RFP does **not** obligate the County to award a contract or pay any costs incurred in proposal preparation.

- All proposals become public records upon award, subject to Oregon Public Records Law.
- Any contract awarded will be subject to **County Counsel review** and must comply with all applicable federal, state, and local laws.

If you'd like, I can now:

- Draft a **Board resolution** that explicitly links this RFP to your economic development goals and the preference for locally owned banks, or
- Write a **one-page talking points sheet** you can use when you explain this shift to the public and to the current provider.